UK & BRITISH ISLES | MINERAL PROSPECTIVITY SERIES

GOLD & SILVER DEPOSITS

A geological assessment of established districts, high-grade lodes and new exploration potential

CURRENT OPERATIONS | HISTORICAL FIELDS | CONCEALED TARGETS | RICH-SEAM POTENTIAL

01
Gold lodes & ore shoots

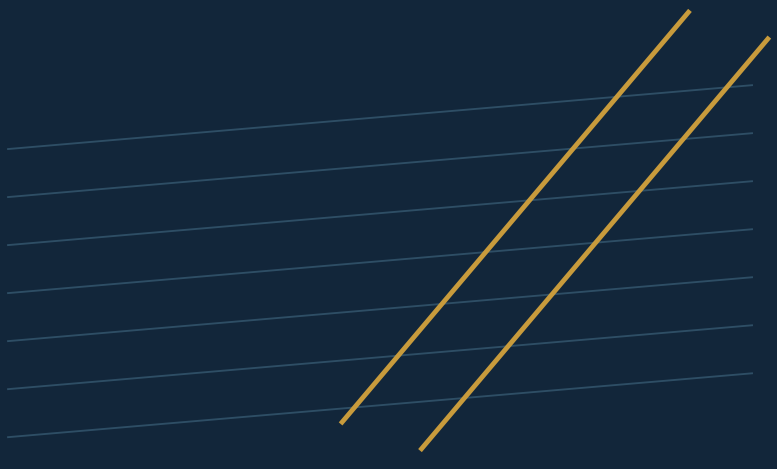
02
Silver-bearing Pb-Zn systems

03
New exploration frontiers

Desktop assessment | Public geological and project information | Status checked 17 October 2026

Research cut-off: 17 October 2026

Prepared as a regional desktop study using publicly available government geology, historic mineral reports and company-reported exploration results.



01 | KEY FINDINGS

Executive summary

The British Isles contain several distinct gold and silver systems, but the exploration opportunity is uneven. The strongest near-term evidence is concentrated in (i) high-grade orogenic gold veins in the Scottish Caledonian/Dalradian belts and Northern Ireland, (ii) the historic Dolgellau gold-belt of north Wales, and (iii) extensive lead-zinc vein fields that historically yielded silver as a co-product. A new, early-stage gold-mineralised breccia pipe at Ardlochan in southwest Scotland adds a less conventional target type. [1-3, 6, 8, 12]

The central commercial distinction is between grade, continuity and mineability. Very high assay intervals can occur in narrow shoots, small pods or isolated samples. They do not prove that a mineable volume exists. Conversely, broad low-grade mineralisation may be substantial but can require large throughput, favourable recoveries and capital-intensive infrastructure. A resource, a reserve, a drill intercept and a historical production figure are different kinds of evidence.

Top-line conclusion

For new exploration, prioritise drill-tested extensions of known high-grade vein systems and the recently identified Ardlochan breccia pipe. For silver, investigate silver-rich lead-zinc systems as polymetallic projects rather than assuming standalone silver mines. Treat untested districts as targets for low-cost screening, not as reserves.

Ranked exploration themes (regional screening, not investment advice)

Rank	Area / system	Evidence snapshot	Assessment
1	Curraghinalt, County Tyrone	Defined high-grade gold-silver-copper deposit; live planning/public inquiry; not approved for development as at the cut-off. [10-11]	Very strong evidence; high consent and environmental friction.
2	Cononish and adjoining Caledonian belt, Scotland	Commercial mine restarted in January 2026; known high-grade gold-silver vein system and regional exploration opportunities. [3]	Operating asset plus expansion exploration; production reliability remains important.
3	Cavanacaw / Omagh, County Tyrone	Known vein system with reported high-grade dilation zones; Kearney vein remains open at depth according to operator. [12]	High-grade shoots plausible; continuity and updated drilling are key.
4	Ardlochan / Lorne Project, southwest Scotland	Drilled mineralised breccia pipe at least 140 m wide; 4 m at 6.73 g/t Au incl. 1 m at 23.6 g/t; broader intercept averages 0.36 g/t over 195 m. [1-2]	Intriguing new target, but early-stage and not a resource.
5	Dolgellau gold-belt, north Wales	Historic gold production and sporadic high-grade quartz-vein shoots; current Clogau bulk sampling had not yet demonstrated economic grades in the first test material. [6, 21-22]	Potential exists, but grade continuity and selective mining risk are material.
6	Clontibret and Longford-Down trends, Ireland	A published company-reported resource at Clontibret and ongoing exploration along district-scale trends. [13-15]	Potential scale; resource model, metallurgy, permitting and project economics require updating.
7	Northern Pennines / Lake District / Isle of Man	Large historic vein districts with silver-bearing galena; exceptional local silver grades are documented but normally not representative. [8-9]	Silver is generally a by-product of Pb-Zn systems; environmental legacy is significant.

Scope note: “British Isles” is used geographically for Great Britain, Northern Ireland, the Republic of Ireland and the Isle of Man. Ireland is a separate state; its licences and permitting systems are distinct from the UK.

02 | METHOD AND CONFIDENCE

How to read the evidence

This assessment weighs five dimensions: (1) direct evidence of mineralisation, (2) grade and style, (3) evidence for lateral/depth continuity, (4) supporting geology and geochemistry, and (5) development constraints. Scores are qualitative judgement aids; they are not probabilistic discovery scores and do not imply a mineral resource.

Evidence classes used throughout the report

Evidence class	What it does and does not prove
Operating / producing	Material is being mined or processed at a site. Current operating status can change rapidly and does not guarantee profitability.
Defined project / resource	A company or public report has presented a resource estimate or feasibility-stage project. The estimate must be date-stamped and its classification retained.
Drilled mineralisation	Assays from drill holes demonstrate metal at specific intervals. True width, geometry, continuity, dilution and recovery remain relevant.
Historic mine / occurrence	Past extraction or mineralised outcrop demonstrates occurrence but not necessarily remaining mineable tonnage.
Conceptual target	A geological model suggests a possible extension or target requiring mapping, sampling, geophysics and drilling.

Resource and reserve terminology

A mineral occurrence is a documented instance of mineralisation. A mineral resource requires geological evidence sufficient to estimate tonnage and grade with a stated level of confidence under a recognised reporting code. An ore reserve is the economically mineable part of a measured or indicated resource after applying mining, processing, infrastructure, economic, legal, environmental, social and governmental modifying factors. Historical production, a company exploration target, or a spectacular assay cannot be substituted for a current reserve.

Current status is checked to 17 October 2026 where official or recent project sources are available. Older technical estimates are identified as historic published estimates when no current, verified replacement was found. Company exploration releases are treated as company-reported data rather than independent confirmation.

A note on “rich seams”

Gold and silver are rarely described most precisely as simple seams. The more useful exploration terms are lodes, veins, vein shoots, breccia pipes, stockworks, replacement bodies and mineralised stratigraphic horizons. A high-grade ore shoot may be only a small, discontinuous part of a much longer vein.

03 | FROM HOST ROCK TO ORE SHOOT

Geological models that matter

Gold and silver occur in the British Isles in several geological settings. Exploration is most efficient where the deposit model predicts both metal concentration and the structures that may localise it.

1. Orogenic / mesothermal gold veins

Typical hosts include deformed metasedimentary rocks, volcanic rocks and competent units within older metamorphic belts. Hot fluids use faults, shears, fold hinges and fracture networks. Gold commonly occurs with quartz, pyrite, arsenopyrite, pyrrhotite, chalcopyrite and locally telluride minerals. At vein intersections, jogs or lithological contacts, changing pressure and fluid chemistry can create higher-grade shoots. The Dalradian belts of Scotland and Northern Ireland and the Dolgellau district in Wales illustrate related but not identical settings. [6-7, 17-18]

2. Porphyry-related stockwork and breccia-pipe gold-copper

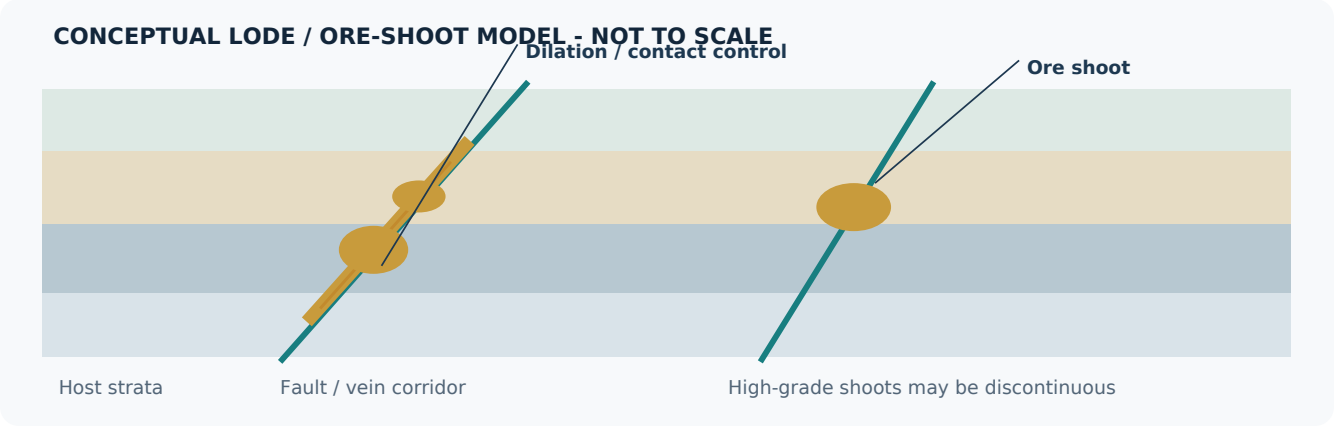
Intrusive systems can generate disseminated mineralisation, veins and breccias. Grades may be variable: a large body can contain a broad low-grade envelope with much narrower higher-grade intervals. Ardlochan is a current UK example of a drilled gold-bearing breccia pipe. The critical questions are its three-dimensional geometry, depth persistence, alteration zonation, copper association, recovery and continuity of higher-grade zones. [1-2]

3. Structurally controlled gold in sedimentary successions

At Dolaucothi in central Wales, gold occurs in quartz veins and pyritiferous shales within a folded and sheared Ordovician-Silurian succession. Faults and folds associated with deformation are interpreted as controls. That makes structural mapping and geochemistry important, but the historic workings do not prove an unmined economic deposit remains. [7, 18]

4. Silver in lead-zinc veins and replacement bodies

Across the northern Pennines, Lake District, central Wales and parts of the Isle of Man, galena (PbS) and sphalerite (ZnS) dominate many metalliferous veins. Silver may be dissolved in galena or occur in minor silver-bearing sulphosalts. Historical recovery often depended on lead smelting and desilverisation rather than a dedicated silver mine. Local high assays are real but highly selective and are not representative of entire lodes. [8-9, 19]



The diagram is conceptual: lode intersections, lithological contacts and dilation zones can localise higher-grade shoots, but real geometries are three-dimensional and require drilling to establish true width and continuity.

04 | SCREENING MATRIX

Regional prospectivity at a glance

Region	Main metals	Relative screen	Why it ranks here
Southwest Scotland: Ardlochan / Lorne	Gold +/- Cu	Very high exploration interest	New drilled breccia-pipe discovery, but early-stage. [1-2]
Central Highlands: Cononish / Glen Lyon belt	Gold + silver	High	Active mine; known vein system; nearby targets require independent validation. [3]
Sperrins / Curraghinalt, Northern Ireland	Gold + Ag + Cu + Te/Sb/Bi	Very high geology; high development friction	Defined deposit under public-inquiry process; approval unresolved. [10-11]
Omagh / Cavanacaw, Northern Ireland	Gold +/- sulphides	High	Drilled veins and reported high-grade dilation zones; extensions remain target concepts. [12]
Dolgellau / Clogau / Gwynfynydd, Wales	Gold + sulphides; local Ag/Pb/Zn	High geological interest; challenging mineability	Historic production and high-grade shoots; modern tests still need to prove grades at scale. [6, 21-22]
Clontibret / Longford-Down, Ireland	Gold +/- base metals	High exploration interest	Published resource and multiple regional targets, but company-reported estimates and targets need date and classification discipline. [13-15]
Central Wales / Dolaucothi and Welsh Basin	Gold + Pb-Zn-Ag	Moderate to high conceptual interest	Historic workings, structural controls and broad regional anomalies; no assumption of a current resource. [7,18-19]
North Pennines / Lake District / Manx orefields	Ag + Pb-Zn; local Co-Ni-Cu	High silver mineralisation evidence	Large historical silver by-product base; not automatically a viable standalone silver opportunity. [8-9]
Gairloch / Loch Maree, Scotland	Au + Cu + Zn	Moderate, model-dependent	Banded iron formation and volcanosedimentary targets; known Gairloch deposit was historically deemed subeconomic/deformed. [17]
Southwest England, Cornwall / Devon	Ag as by-product; Au local/low confidence	Lower priority for primary gold, selective silver/base-metal research	Tin-copper granites and polymetallic vein systems; test existing datasets before greenfield drilling. [4, 19]

Interpretation: “Very high” or “high” means favourable evidence for further geological work; it is not a statement that a profitable mine is likely. Protected landscapes, water systems, access, legacy contamination and licensing can materially lower a project’s practical priority.

05 | CENTRAL HIGHLANDS AND SOUTHWEST SCOTLAND

Scotland: the most dynamic new gold story

Scotland combines an existing gold-producing asset with established high-grade vein mineralisation and a recently drilled, different-style target in southwest Scotland. This diversity is a strong reason to place Scotland near the top of any UK gold exploration shortlist.

Cononish, near Tyndrum

Cononish is a narrow-vein gold-silver deposit within the Caledonian belt. After the previous operator, Scotgold Resources, entered administration in November 2023, the mine was acquired by Acrux Sorting Technology in 2025; production was reported to have resumed in January 2026. Recent reporting describes upgrades to underground power and ventilation, new ore-sorting equipment and a target of scaling to around 2,000 ounces of gold per month. This is a production ambition, not proof of sustained realised output. [3]

An older feasibility-era estimate reported 617,000 tonnes at an average 13.4 g/t Au and 55.3 g/t Ag in total measured, indicated and inferred resources, and a 2015 reserve estimate of 555,000 tonnes at 11.1 g/t Au and 47.7 g/t Ag. These estimates are historic and must not be read as the operator's current mine plan or a current reserve without reconciliation. Their value here is to illustrate a high-grade, silver-bearing narrow-vein system. [26]

Ardlochan, Argyllshire - a new target style

BGS reported in June 2026 that Western Gold Exploration's 2025 drilling identified a gold-mineralised breccia pipe at least 140 m in diameter. The company's September 2025 release reported a broader intercept averaging 195 m at 0.36 g/t Au from 30 m down-hole, using a 0.1 g/t cut-off, with a higher-grade interval of 4 m at 6.73 g/t Au including 1 m at 23.6 g/t. A separate 1 m interval reported 1.11 g/t Au, 22.4 g/t Ag and 0.45% Cu. [1-2]

Why Ardlochan is interesting - and why caution is essential

The pipe has scale and demonstrated gold anomalism, but the broad reported average is low compared with the narrow high-grade veins at Cononish or Curraghinalt. Drill intercept length is not true thickness; one set of shallow holes cannot establish a resource, depth continuity, recoveries or economic cut-off. Follow-up drilling should test vertical geometry and the continuity of high-grade breccia phases.

Other Scottish targets

Calliachar / Urlar Burn and other Dalradian-belt prospects warrant review alongside Cononish. The Glen Lyon joint venture has also been reported as seeking exploration licences over approximately 500 square kilometres near Cononish. In the northwest, Gairloch and the Loch Maree belt have gold-bearing volcanogenic / banded-iron-formation associations; however, the historically studied Gairloch copper-gold deposit was considered too small and deformed to be economic. Geological analogies are a guide to targeting, not proof of an orebody. [3, 4, 17]

06 | DOLGELLAU, DOLAUCOTHI AND THE WELSH BASIN

Wales: famous high-grade gold, uneven continuity

Dolgellau gold-belt

The Dolgellau belt lies on the southeastern side of the Harlech Dome, where Cambrian sedimentary rocks and greenstone intrusions host quartz-sulphide veins. The principal historical mines include Clogau-St David's and Gwynfynydd. BGS regional material records about 120,000 ounces of gold from these two mines collectively; Eryri's local heritage account notes that Clogau produced more than two tonnes of gold from the 1860s to 1911. Historical figures vary by source and mine boundary, but both demonstrate real production. [6, 21, 23]

A key geological characteristic is the distribution of gold in small, rich, steeply dipping shoots rather than uniformly along the full vein. Veins commonly trend northeast and can extend for kilometres; ore concentrations were historically associated with particular host-rock contacts, intrusions and sulphide assemblages. The implication is a strong potential for local high grades, but a significant risk that intersections between old workings and new drilling miss or poorly represent the productive shoot geometry. [6, 18, 23]

Current Clogau work and the "rich seam" question

Clogau-St David's remains a credible geological exploration target, with underground development and bulk sampling reported during 2025-26. However, a half-yearly update for the period ended 31 May 2026 reported that the first roughly 16 tonnes of material processed from the early blasts returned uneconomic gold grades in concentrates; further work was continuing to understand sulphide-hosted gold and processing. This is an essential counterweight to the mine's premium Welsh-gold brand and historic selective grades. [22]

A rational Clogau exploration hypothesis

Map and model the old stopes, lode intersections, intrusive contacts and sulphide-rich zones in 3D; drill across specific ore-shoot hypotheses; then take representative bulk samples large enough to assess grade variability and metallurgical recovery. Do not extrapolate historic hand-picked / selectively mined grades to a whole vein or district.

Dolaucothi and central Wales

At Dolaucothi near Pumpsaint, gold occurs in quartz-vein structures and pyritiferous shales in a folded and sheared Ordovician-Silurian succession. Historic exploitation includes Roman workings and later production into the 20th century. The BGS interpretation links localisation to northeast-trending folds and faults associated with Acadian deformation. A broader Lower Palaeozoic Welsh Basin appraisal concluded that structural controls and regional geochemistry could help identify mesothermal gold and volcanogenic massive-sulphide (VMS) targets. [7, 18]

For modern exploration, central Wales merits a staged reappraisal of stream-sediment data, historical adits, structural intersections and archived geochemical surveys. The likely priority is target generation and limited verification rather than assuming a large, continuous deposit. The same districts may merit silver-lead-zinc co-product work where historic polymetallic veins cut favourable formations. [18-19]

07 | CURRAGHINALT AND CAVANACAW

Northern Ireland: defined gold potential, unresolved consent

Northern Ireland's Dalradian Supergroup hosts two significant gold-vein project areas: Curraghinalt in the Sperrins and Cavanacaw / Omagh to the west. Both demonstrate that British Isles gold potential extends beyond historic Welsh workings.

Curraghinalt, County Tyrone

Curraghinalt is a high-grade gold-bearing vein system with associated silver and copper, and minor critical-element potential including tellurium, antimony and bismuth. A historic feasibility-era reserve estimate cited 5.24 million tonnes at 8.54 g/t Au and 3.9 g/t Ag, containing approximately 1.44 million ounces of gold and 0.66 million ounces of silver. These are historic project figures and must be checked against the current technical report before financial use. [11]

As at 17 October 2026, the project remained under an active public-inquiry process involving planning and related water/consent applications. The Planning Appeals Commission's public updates show proceedings during 2026 and continuing submissions from parties. The project is therefore a major geological prospect, but it must not be represented as a permitted or operating mine. Environmental acceptability, water management, tailings, landscape impacts and community consent are central development uncertainties. [10, 24]

Cavanacaw / Omagh Project

Cavanacaw comprises sulphide-rich, gold-bearing veins in a favourable host sequence. Galantas has reported high-grade dilation-zone drill intercepts on the Kearney Vein of 7 m at 31.7 g/t Au (estimated true thickness 3.3 m) and 4.4 m at 31.8 g/t Au (estimated true thickness 3.0 m). The company describes the Kearney Vein as roughly 850 m in drilled strike length and open down plunge. These are high-grade intercepts in particular vein zones, not a proxy for whole-deposit grade. [12]

Galantas has identified a possible concealed Kearney North ore shoot, roughly 180 m north of the known vein extent, supported by a historical base-of-till anomaly of 31.5 g/t Au; the announcement describes a planned three-hole, approximately 1,000 m drilling programme. The web page carries a 2026 date but its body also references the original 2024 announcement, so project execution and results should be verified before treating the target as drilled. [12]

Northern Ireland ranking

Curraghinalt offers the strongest combination of defined geological scale and precious-metal grade, but with the highest consent sensitivity. Cavanacaw provides a more focused vein-extension exploration concept, where the key question is whether the known high-grade shoots continue at depth and along strike.

08 | LONGFORD-DOWN AND TELLUS PROSPECTIVITY

Ireland: district-scale gold targets

The Republic of Ireland is not part of the UK, but its gold systems sit within regional geological belts that continue into Northern Ireland. It therefore provides useful comparators for the wider British Isles, while mining licences and development law remain separate.

Clontibret and the Longford-Down trends

Conroy Gold's published project overview reports a JORC 2012 resource at Clontibret of 517,000 ounces of gold at 2.0 g/t Au, comprising 320,000 ounces indicated and 197,000 ounces inferred at a 1.0 g/t cut-off. The company states that this resource represents only a portion of the broader target. This is a company-reported estimate, not a current reserve or proof of project economics; it should be validated against the latest competent-person report before being used in valuation. [14]

The wider Longford-Down project includes district-scale anomalous trends, with Clontibret in the Orlock Bridge trend and additional targets including Glenish and other prospects. Conroy's July 2026 update described follow-on drilling and assay results intended to test continuity along strike and at depth. A company report also highlighted high-grade surface / trench results at Creenkill in the Skullmartin trend; such isolated high-grade samples are best used to rank targets, not to estimate tonnes. [14-15]

Tellus Border survey targets

Geological Survey Ireland's Tellus Border mineral exploration work combined stream / soil geochemistry, geophysics, bedrock lithology, rock age and major structural features to identify four prospective areas for additional sampling and mapping: Glenties and Milford in County Donegal, Manorhamilton in County Leitrim and Shercock in County Cavan. All four were assessed as prospective for gold, while Shercock and Glenties were also considered prospective for base metals. These are regional prospectivity findings rather than deposits. [13]

Silver and base-metal context

Ireland's major historical zinc-lead deposits such as Navan, Silvermines and Tynagh were hosted in Carboniferous carbonate / calcareous sequences. Silver can occur with lead-zinc mineralisation, but the public sources reviewed here do not establish a standalone modern silver reserve for these historic districts. For any tailings or residual-ore concept, the first step would be assay of representative material, mineralogical characterisation, contaminant review, recovery testwork and a net environmental benefit assessment. [20]

Most useful Irish exploration action

Re-process historic data and modern Tellus geochemistry in a 3D structural / lithological model; rank anomalies by coincident gold, pathfinder elements and major faults; then conduct infill sampling and drilling only where independent QA/QC and access/licence conditions support it.

09 | WHERE THE GEOLOGY IS WEAKER OR DIFFERENT

England and the wider UK gold frontier

England has many metalliferous districts, but the strongest gold-focused UK evidence clusters in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland. In England, potential often presents as local gold occurrence, placer/alluvial concentration, or gold within polymetallic systems rather than a presently defined large primary-gold project.

Cornwall and Devon

Southwest England's mineral systems are closely linked to granites and late-stage hydrothermal activity. Historical mining chiefly targeted tin, copper, tungsten and arsenic-bearing systems, along with lead-zinc veins. These deposits and associated altered rocks are reasonable places to review old data for trace gold and silver, but a geochemical signal in a tin-copper district is not itself a gold deposit. BGS recommends existing exploration and geological map datasets as the starting point for prospectivity work. [4-5]

Lake District and Northern England

The Lake District and northern Pennines are much more firmly established as lead-zinc-fluorspar-baryte vein provinces, with important silver by-product history. They contain a variety of sulphide minerals and local polymetallic occurrences, but gold is not the dominant economic case in most documented veins. Exploration should focus on metal associations supported by assays and mineralogy rather than assume high gold grade from the existence of an old mine. [8-9]

Gairloch / Loch Maree and northwest Scotland

Gairloch is geologically intriguing because gold and base-metal mineralisation occurs within older volcanosedimentary and iron-rich exhalative sequences. The historical Gairloch copper-gold deposit was described by BGS research as too small and deformed to be economic, but further targets in the wider belt have been studied. Its value for a modern programme is as a data-rich regional screening area where historic geophysics and geochemistry can be revisited, not as an established gold resource. [17]

Alluvial / placer gold

Alluvial gold in Scottish streams and elsewhere demonstrates that gold has been eroded from upstream sources. It can help prioritise catchments for stream-sediment sampling, but grain counts and nugget finds are not reliable substitutes for bedrock drilling. Glacial transport, stream sorting and the nugget effect can move gold away from its source and create highly discontinuous concentrations. Any panning or prospecting must comply with land access, mineral ownership, environmental and watercourse rules.

Lower-cost frontier work

Use public BGS / GSI mapping, historical mine reports, regional geochemical grids and archived drill-core data to identify overlooked targets before commissioning expensive new geophysics or drilling. The UK's Mineral Reconnaissance Programme has 146 reports available through BGS and the data are a strong first-pass exploration asset. [4-5]

10 | NORTHERN PENNINES, LAKE DISTRICT AND ISLE OF MAN

Silver: strongest established districts

The clearest silver story across Britain is historical recovery as a by-product from lead ores. This matters because the geology, mining methods, processing plant and revenues are linked to the main metal (typically lead or zinc), not silver alone.

Northern Pennine Orefield

The Alston Block and adjoining Northumberland Trough host extensive Carboniferous-hosted veins, with galena and sphalerite as the main ore minerals. BGS reports typical silver contents in northern Pennine galena of about 112-224 parts per million (ppm), equivalent to 4-8 ounces of silver per ton of lead metal, while exceptional local results up to about 2,511 ppm Ag (around 90 oz per ton of lead) have been reported. Those exceptions are highly local and must not be extrapolated to the whole vein system. [8-9]

BGS records that at least 170 tons of silver were recovered from northern Pennine lead ores during the 18th and 19th centuries. Earlier historical accounts cite 5.45 million ounces of silver recovered from lead concentrates over 1729-1870, while recorded output estimates vary with the district and source. The essential geological point is secure: the district has substantial silver-bearing galena, but the silver grade is distributed unevenly. [8-9]

Lake District

Lead-zinc veins in the Lake District historically carried silver at levels that supported desilverisation. A modern reappraisal might examine old mine workings, spoil heaps and archived assays for silver, cobalt, nickel, copper and zinc. However, historic mine waste can be environmentally contaminated and physically unstable; it must be evaluated as a regulated remediation / resource-recovery problem, not assumed available for reprocessing.

Isle of Man

The island’s historical lead-zinc vein systems, including Laxey and Foxdale, are known for silver-bearing ore. BGS regional summaries note silver values around 420 ppm at some mines and average values around 1,120 ppm Ag in Laxey ore, with local Foxdale values above 10,000 ppm associated with silver-rich tetrahedrite. These are historical analytical records; current mineralogical verification and representative bulk sampling would be required before any modern reprocessing proposition. [8-9]

Silver opportunity test

For a specific old mine or tailings site, establish (1) silver grade distribution, (2) association with lead, zinc and sulphosalts, (3) liberation and recovery, (4) payable metal terms and penalties, and (5) environmental liabilities. If Pb-Zn grades or recovery are weak, silver alone may not carry the project economics.

11 | SECONDARY BUT MATERIAL PROSPECTS

Silver-bearing lodes in Wales and southwest England

Central Wales

The historic Central Wales Mining Field contains lead-zinc veins and stockworks, locally with silver and other sulphides. BGS district descriptions note that mineralised vein stockworks can be tens of metres wide, while only the highest-grade sections, often less than a metre across, were normally worked. These systems are useful analogues for high-grade lode targeting, but the historical emphasis on selected vein widths is a warning against overestimating average grades. [19]

Dolgellau and the Harlech Dome

The Dolgellau gold-belt contains quartz-sulphide veins in which gold and silver occur with copper, lead and zinc sulphides. Multiple mineral assemblages occur across the district; the metal distribution can change between veins and even along one vein. This makes multi-element assays (Au, Ag, Pb, Zn, Cu, As, Sb, Bi, Te) valuable for both target ranking and processing design. [6, 23]

Cornwall and Devon

Southwest England hosts granite-related hydrothermal mineralisation and a long history of tin-copper extraction. Silver can be associated with galena and complex polymetallic veins. The best modern concept is selective reassessment of historic mine datasets and waste material, rather than assuming a new primary silver district. The main economic model would typically require payable by-products or a credible small-scale / niche value proposition, backed by modern assay and metallurgy. [4-5]

Irish base-metal districts

Tynagh, Silvermines and Navan demonstrate the scale of Ireland’s carbonate-hosted base-metal province, but are primarily zinc-lead deposits. Historic deposits are not synonymous with presently available resources, and silver is usually a coproduct of lead-bearing mineralisation. A project concept based on historical mine residues would need a new inventory, sampling programme, metallurgical tests, drainage chemistry and site-remediation plan. [20]

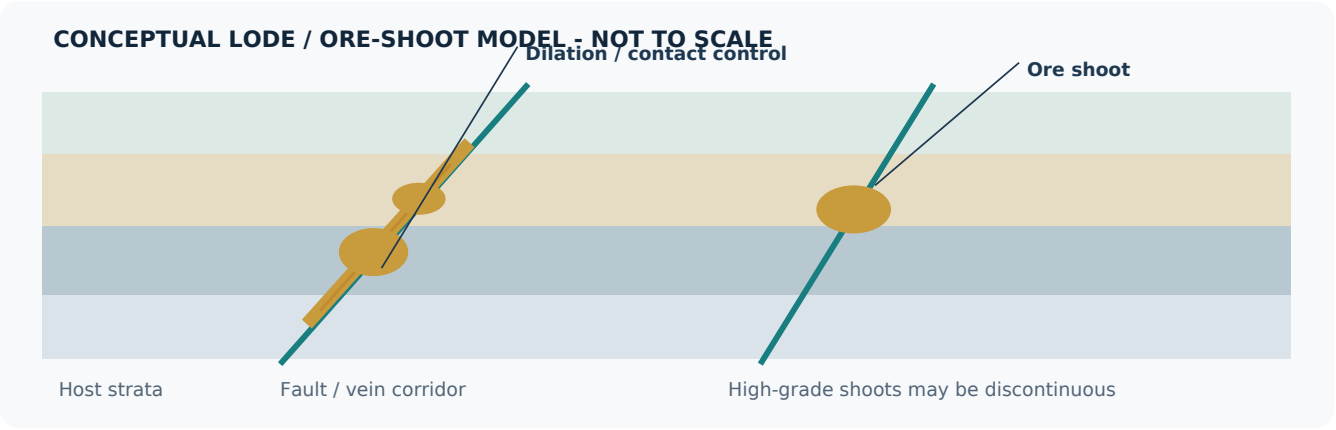
Could Britain host a standalone silver mine?

The geological record confirms silver-bearing ores and some locally very silver-rich specimens, but the public evidence reviewed for this report does not identify a currently operating, standalone primary silver mine in the UK or a new primary-silver reserve ready for development. The more defensible strategy is to assess silver as a coproduct of gold, lead-zinc or polymetallic deposits, and to look for local silver-rich shoots using mineralogy and structural evidence.

12 | HIGH-GRADE SHOOT POTENTIAL

Where could the richest lodes or “seams” occur?

A lode may be long but low grade over much of its length. Economic mining often depends on local ore shoots created by changes in structure, host-rock competency, fluid chemistry or mineralogy. A useful programme asks where grade is concentrated, and how reproducibly that concentration can be mined.



Priority high-grade hypotheses

Target style	British Isles analogue / reason	Best test
1. Vein intersections and fault jogs	Gold lodes at Cavanacaw / Curraghinalt; historical and current high-grade intervals indicate shoot-scale grade concentration.	Map the full structural network and drill across inferred dilation zones; do not project a single intercept too far.
2. Intrusion / host-rock contacts	Clogau and other Dolgellau-belt veins show a relationship between mineralised shoots, particular host formations and intrusions.	3D model historic workings, contact geometry and sulphide zones; sample across the full lode width.
3. Breccia-pipe internal phases	Ardlochan provides a newly drilled example of broad gold anomalism with narrower high-grade intervals.	Test pipe geometry and internal phases at depth; use oriented core, density and multi-element assays.
4. Fold hinges and shear corridors	Dolaucothi and the Welsh Basin contain gold in folded/sheared rocks and quartz-vein structures.	Combine structural mapping, alteration mineralogy, soil/stream geochemistry and targeted drilling.
5. Silver-rich galena / sulphosalt shoots	North Pennine and Manx orefields have highly variable silver; local rich zones are historically documented.	Use mineralogical analysis and systematic channel sampling; ensure the lead-zinc product is also viable.
6. Concealed ore shoots beneath cover	Cavanacaw Kearney North and other fault-hosted vein extensions are examples of this target class.	Use historical base-of-till, soil geochemistry, downhole EM/resistivity where appropriate, then drill-test.

What counts as a “rich” target?

An isolated 20-30 g/t Au assay may be important but not decisive. The exploration question is whether high grade occurs across an adequate true width and is repeated along strike and down plunge, with mining dilution and metallurgical recovery accounted for. For silver, high ppm values in galena need to be translated into recoverable silver per tonne of ore and a marketable concentrate.

13 | FROM DESKTOP SCREENING TO DRILL TARGETS

Recommended exploration programme

A disciplined programme should progress through staged decision gates. Each stage should either improve the three-dimensional geological model or reduce a key uncertainty; otherwise capital should not roll forward.

Stage 1 - Data audit and target inventory

Compile BGS geological maps and memoirs, Mineral Reconnaissance Programme / MEIGA reports, mine plans, shaft and adit records, historic mine production, geochemistry, geophysics, drill logs and company disclosures. Build a georeferenced database with source, date, coordinate quality and confidence. BGS has made historic exploration information available via the National Geoscience Data Centre and the MRP archive; GSI provides exploration reports and GOLDMINE / GeoData resources for the Republic of Ireland. [4-5, 25]

Stage 2 - Regional geochemistry and structural modelling

Reprocess stream-sediment and soil geochemistry for gold and silver plus pathfinders appropriate to the deposit model. For orogenic gold, useful vectors can include As, Sb, Bi, Te, W and sulphide indicators; for polymetallic vein systems, include Pb, Zn, Cu, As, Sb and Ba. Correct for lithology, drainage, glacial transport, sample medium and analytical detection limits. Combine the geochemistry with faults, fold axes, lithological contacts, intrusive margins and known mineralised trends. [13, 17-18]

Stage 3 - Field validation and systematic sampling

Map veins and alterations; sample channel/trench exposures across full widths where possible; assay blanks, certified reference materials and duplicates; retain chain of custody; and check for nugget effects. For historical waste or tailings, first establish ownership, safety, environmental status, representative sampling design and whether processing could improve remediation outcomes.

Stage 4 - Geophysics and drilling

Use geophysics only where it addresses a specific geological question. Magnetic, electromagnetic, IP/resistivity and gravity methods can help map sulphides, alteration, structures or density contrasts, but none directly measures gold grade. Orient drilling to intersect the target at a high angle; report down-hole length and estimated true width separately; drill step-outs to test continuity. Use rigorous QA/QC and independent assay check laboratories.

Stage 5 - Resource and metallurgy

Only after sufficient drilling, density measurements, geological domaining and grade-control data should a compliant resource estimate be commissioned. Metallurgical testing must test gold recovery (free gold, refractory/sulphide-hosted gold), gravity separation, flotation, leaching, silver deportment, concentrate impurities and variability across ore types. Resource growth does not automatically imply reserve growth.

14 | GRADE IS ONLY ONE VARIABLE

Commercial screen: what makes a mine viable?

The report does not forecast gold or silver prices, project capex or returns. A defensible economic screen should avoid a single universal cut-off grade because it depends on mining method, depth, vein width, costs, recoveries, by-product credits, infrastructure, taxes, royalties and permitting.

Narrow high-grade veins vs broad low-grade systems

Deposit / business model	Potential advantage	Key risks
Narrow, steeply dipping high-grade lodes	Can be attractive at relatively small tonnage if grade continuity, access and dilution are controlled.	Selective mining, ground conditions, irregular ore shoots, development metres per tonne, ventilation and high unit costs.
Broad, lower-grade breccia / stockwork	Potential for scale and mechanised mining if geometry and metallurgy support it.	Large throughput, high capital intensity, recovery variability, waste movement and cut-off sensitivity.
Silver in lead-zinc ore	May add revenue to an existing base-metal circuit.	Silver deportment into concentrate, smelter terms, penalties, lead/zinc grades, environmental treatment and by-product payability.
Historic mine waste / tailings	Potential secondary resource and remediation opportunity.	Unrepresentative historic assays, oxidation, fine particle liberation, acid/metalliferous drainage, land ownership and waste regulation.

Minimum technical work before an investment decision

At a minimum: a current geological model; defensible resource estimate or explicit exploration target; representative and independent assays; bulk density and true-width estimates; metallurgical recovery and deleterious-element tests; mine design and dilution assumptions; hydrogeology/geotechnics; power, water, transport and tailings concept; environmental baseline; planning and licence pathway; closure liabilities; a sensitivity-tested economic model; and an independent review by qualified professionals.

Market premium vs contained metal

A Welsh-gold provenance or jewellery premium can support a niche product strategy, but that premium applies only to traceable, saleable gold meeting buyer specifications. It cannot be applied to all in-situ gold ounces. Likewise, a silver-bearing concentrate may realise less than spot-price value after recovery loss, treatment charges, payable-metal terms, refining charges and penalties. These differences belong in the product and cash-flow model, not in the headline in-situ metal value.

Commercial discipline

Do not calculate project value by multiplying a reported ounce figure by spot price. Contained metal is not recovered metal, recovered metal is not payable metal, and payable metal is not profit.

15 | THE GEOLOGY IS ONLY ONE GATE

Environmental and consenting constraints

The most prospective historic mining districts often sit in sensitive upland landscapes, protected habitats, drinking-water catchments or communities with long histories of mining impacts. Geological prospectivity should be ranked separately from consent feasibility.

Key screening items

- Protected landscapes and habitats: Cononish sits within Loch Lomond & The Trossachs National Park; parts of the Dolgellau belt lie within Eryri / Snowdonia; the Curraghinalt proposal raises issues in the Sperrins landscape. Assess siting, visibility, habitat and alternatives early. [3, 10, 21]
- Water and tailings: Baseline surface-water and groundwater chemistry, flow regimes, geochemistry of waste rock, sulphide oxidation, tailings stability and closure design are core issues, not late-stage extras.
- Legacy mine liabilities: Old workings, shafts and waste piles may be unsafe or contaminated. Reprocessing is not a free option; the project may inherit waste management, subsidence, land access or treatment costs.
- Historic heritage and rights: Workings and industrial landscapes can have heritage value. Land access, mineral title, planning permissions, exploration licences and water consents must be confirmed before field work.
- Community trust: Provide transparent monitoring data, independent review, clear closure funding and a realistic distinction between exploration and a proposed mine. Inquiry status is particularly material at Curraghinalt. [10, 24]
- Responsible sampling: Any field campaign needs legal permission, safe access, appropriate sample handling and controls to avoid damage to streams, peat, habitats and old mine features.

Northern Ireland status example

Curraghinalt is a useful caution: a substantial defined deposit and long-running technical work do not remove the need for planning, water and other regulatory consent. As of the report cut-off, the Planning Appeals Commission was still publishing inquiry updates and evidence submissions. The project cannot be represented as approved or ready for construction on geology alone. [10-11, 24]

Environmental upside case

A well-designed project might also recover metals from existing mine waste or remediate historic drainage, but only if independent analysis shows the recovery route improves overall outcomes. Reprocessing must not destabilise waste facilities, remobilise contaminants or shift liabilities to the public. Any secondary-resource business case should include closure and water-treatment costs from the beginning.

16 | BEST TARGETS FOR FURTHER WORK

Recommended priority portfolio

Priority	Area	Recommended next step	Time horizon	Reason / risk
A1	Cononish / Glen Lyon, Scotland	Mine-adjacent step-outs; vein geometry and grade control; independent production/recovery data.	Short to medium term	High geological evidence; existing mine infrastructure; operational risk.
A2	Cavanacaw / Omagh, Northern Ireland	Test Kearney down-plunge and north extension; verify current drilling status and resource.	Short to medium term	High-grade vein evidence; continuity remains the main question.
A3	Ardlochan / Lorne, Scotland	Follow-up drilling on breccia pipe depth, dimensions, internal high-grade zones and Cu/Ag association.	Medium term	New discovery; potentially different scale model; no resource yet.
B1	Dolgellau / Clogau, Wales	Reconcile historic stope plans, current bulk sampling, sulphide-hosted gold and metallurgical recovery.	Short term diagnostic; longer-term exploration	Historic grade potential is high but modern economic grades unproven in recent initial bulk tests.
B2	Curraghinalt, Northern Ireland	Track updated technical studies and inquiry determination; no speculative assumption of approval.	Regulatory / technical diligence	High defined geological potential; high consent and environmental risk.
B3	Clontibret / Longford-Down, Ireland	Update competent-person resource; follow-up structural / step-out drilling; integrate Tellus regional anomalies.	Medium term	District-scale potential, but corporate estimates and targets need verification.
C1	Central Wales / Dolaucothi	GIS / archive-led target generation, geochemical reanalysis and selective field checks.	Low-cost early stage	Credible historic mineralisation; no current resource established here.
C2	Northern Pennines / Manx silver systems	Re-assay representative lode material and waste inventories; test Pb-Zn-Silver co-product model.	Target-specific	Historic silver recovery is real; standalone silver case is unproven.
C3	Gairloch / Loch Maree and southwest England	Revisit MRP / MEIGA / historic geophysical and geochemical data; rank before field spend.	Low-cost screening	Potential exists but public evidence does not demonstrate a current economic precious-metal resource.

A-stage projects already have relatively strong evidence or active project context. B-stage projects warrant specific verification or development diligence. C-stage areas are candidates for data-led target generation, not immediate mining proposals. Timing is relative to work readiness, licensing, seasonal access and data availability, not a commitment that an economic discovery will be made.

17 | AN EFFICIENT 18-24 MONTH PROGRAMME

Implementation plan and decision gates

Stage	Workstream	Core work	Decision rule
Gate 0: 0-2 months	Data room / title / constraints	Compile BGS, GSI, mine plans, licences, access rights, land status and conservation constraints. Define one accountable dataset and coordinate system.	Proceed only where the target and data provenance are clear.
Gate 1: 2-5 months	Desktop model and reconnaissance	3D structural interpretation; geochemical reprocessing; historical assay audit; field validation plan; independent technical review.	Drop targets with no coherent model or no safe/legal access.
Gate 2: 5-9 months	Sampling and geophysics	Systematic channel / soil / stream sampling; QA/QC; mineralogy; ground geophysics only where it tests a hypothesis.	Require repeatable anomalism and a drillable geometry.
Gate 3: 9-15 months	First-pass drilling	Oriented core, step-outs, assay QA/QC, true-width assessment, density, structural logging, alteration and metallurgy samples.	Require continuity, width and grade support; no decision on isolated headline assays alone.
Gate 4: 15-24 months	Resource pathway / metallurgy	Follow-up drilling; geometallurgy; preliminary mine and process concepts; water/environment baseline; cost and price sensitivity.	Proceed to resource estimation or feasibility only if technical, economic and consenting cases remain credible.

Data priorities by commodity

Target type	Minimum high-value information
Gold lodes	Historic stope maps; oriented drill-core; true widths; grade distributions; Au + As/Sb/Bi/Te/W chemistry; free-gold vs sulphide-hosted gold; grind/recovery data.
Gold breccia / stockwork	Pipe / stockwork geometry; alteration zoning; Au-Cu-Ag distribution; structural controls; density; variability and recovery testing.
Silver-Pb-Zn	Ag deportment between galena and sulphosalts; Pb-Zn concentrate grades; payable silver; smelter penalties; waste and drainage chemistry.
Historic waste	Representative tonnage survey, sampling grid, leach / flotation tests, drainage / contaminant testing, stability, ownership and closure liability.

A practical starting point

Begin with the public data, not a drill rig. BGS MRP/MEIGA files, BGS memoirs, Geological Survey Ireland Tellus data and company disclosure can often eliminate weak concepts and sharply improve drill targeting at far lower cost than new drilling. [1, 4-5, 13, 25]

18 | WHERE THE STRONGEST CASE SITS

Conclusions

The UK and wider British Isles have meaningful gold and silver geology, but the strongest opportunities are not evenly distributed and should not be conflated.

Gold: The highest-confidence exploration districts are the known high-grade vein systems around Cononish, Curraghinalt and Cavanacaw, plus the historic Dolgellau belt. Cononish's reported restart makes Scotland the most tangible current operating story. Curraghinalt remains a major defined deposit but with unresolved consent status. Cavanacaw offers vein-extension hypotheses, while Clogau is a reminder that spectacular historic grades and provenance value do not remove the need for modern bulk-grade and recovery proof. [3, 6, 10-12, 21-22]

New gold frontier: Ardlochan deserves sustained attention because the drilled breccia-pipe system is a current discovery and its broad gold anomalism coexists with narrower higher-grade zones. The next decision is whether the geometry and higher-grade zones are continuous and recoverable at scale. Southern Scotland, the Central Highlands and the wider Longford-Down belt merit further archive-driven targeting. [1-2, 13-17]

Silver: The most established silver potential is embedded in lead-zinc and polymetallic districts, notably the northern Pennines, Lake District, Isle of Man and central Wales, with additional silver-bearing systems around Dolgellau and in southwest England. The geology demonstrates historical recovery and locally high silver values; the practical project concept is generally a by-product or waste-reprocessing case rather than a standalone primary-silver mine. [8-9, 19-20, 23]

Rich-seam potential: Search for ore shoots at vein intersections, fault jogs, fold hinges, lithological contacts, breccia phases and concealed down-plunge extensions. Use very high-grade assays as target vectors; estimate average grade only from representative, controlled sampling and drilling. A target is credible when grade, width, continuity, recovery and development permissions line up.

Final judgement

The best near-term work is not a speculative hunt for a huge, undiscovered British gold seam. It is a disciplined programme to extend known high-grade systems, test the new Ardlochan breccia discovery, and re-evaluate historic silver-bearing districts as modern polymetallic or remediation-linked opportunities.

Limitations

This is a regional desktop assessment using publicly available information. It is not a qualified person's report, mineral resource estimate, reserve statement, environmental assessment or investment recommendation. Some historic project numbers and company-reported claims may have been superseded. Before financial use, verify the newest technical reports, mineral title, permits, independent assays, metallurgy and official project status. Resource and reserve statements must retain their original classification, effective date and assumptions.

19 | GOVERNMENT AND TECHNICAL SOURCES

Sources and further reading

The references below are clickable in the PDF. Sources are grouped by their main role. Government geological survey material is prioritised for geological setting and historic district character; current company releases are used for time-sensitive exploration and operating status and are identified as company-reported where appropriate.

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https://galantas.com/news/galantas-gold-plans-to-drill-key-target-area-north-of-the-omagh-mine-site/

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20 | PROJECT UPDATES AND DATA PORTALS

Sources and further reading

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[15] Conroy Gold and Natural Resources (6 July 2026), Operational and Corporate Update.
https://www.investegate.co.uk/announcement/prn/conroy-gold-natural-resources-cdi---cgnr/operational-and-corporate-update/9653125

[16] Geological Survey Ireland, Minerals, Precious Metals and Gems.
https://www.gsi.ie/geoscience-topics/geology/minerals-precious-metals-and-gems/

[17] Coats et al. (1997), Mineral exploration in Lewisian supracrustal and basic rocks of the Scottish Highlands and Islands. BGS MRP Report 146.
https://nora.nerc.ac.uk/id/eprint/534627/

[18] Cooper et al. (2000), Potential for mesothermal gold and VMS deposits in the Lower Palaeozoic Welsh Basin. BGS report RR/00/009.
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Selected datasets and technical material are periodically updated. The BGS National Geoscience Data Centre / MRP / MEIGA archive, BGS Onshore GeoIndex, Geological Survey Ireland Tellus datasets and GOLDMINE / GeoData records are particularly useful for moving from this regional assessment to a project-specific target inventory. [4-5, 13, 25]

Report prepared 17 October 2026. All grades and resource figures are reported with the caveats given in the body text. No contained-metal valuation or mine economics has been calculated.